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the issue in which we reject bodily temptations and lift our souls to the light

VOL VI, ISSUE VI, 10/29/2026

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Married in Vegas %

Alex Werth
Your dreamy blue eyes on the ground

Las Vegas, Nevada - In the middle of the American desert stands a glittering glass oasis. Baking by day, shining by night, this is the crown of industrial society's indulgences. Here you can find lovers, gamblers, thrill-seekers, and the modern synthesis thereof: competitive relationship speedrunners.

We find ourselves in Vegas today, under the setting September sun, to catch a glimpse of this ritual. A young gentleman, sharply plumed, swiping quite intently on his cell phone as he waits outside the Mandalay Bay tower. He is racing through his Tinder feed, looking for the spark that will earn him a worthy time on the leaderboards. There it is: swipe right, a green flash. The timer has begun.

At oh-oh-ten, a lady in red bounds from the sliding glass doors, and they high five salaciously. She must have been waiting in the lobby for her prince in latex armor. They fire off pleasantries on the way to the car – names, jobs, pets, homes, love languages, childhood dreams, and whether their middle or oldest child would be the most neglected. Off they drive, taking a right turn at *55* and letting the centrifugal force motivate an endearing snuggle.

Smooth. We go to our boys in the helicopter, who will follow the rest of this magical journey: at just under two minutes, this run has the makings of a winner.

Vegas features one of the most fascinating American institutions, the cornerstone of its thriving speedrunning scene: drive-through chapels. With some good planning, a couple can knock-up and knock-out 60-horsepower leisure. There! We've spotted them, burning down Sammy Davis, golden advertisements bounding across the Sphere. First date at two minutes thirty at ~~Hardee's~~ Carl's Jr., a $1 tip floating in their wake. Second date at 03:14 under the blooming magnolia trees, as they narrowly miss a pickup while they kiss with hair flying. At the chapel, the car only stops for a moment: mobbed by wrinkled ministers and sashaying bridesmaids like piranhas to a cow, our lovers emerge in a cloud of doves and champagne, the car loaded with rental white-ribboned gifts. Marriage in 04:30: spectacularly done.

That makes Relationship% for these lovebirds. A whole world of speedrun routes await them: honeymoon races to spiteful divorces, children and death and filling out *153*-clearance forms. What makes it sweet is not the destination, but the delightful brevity of the journey.

We Don't Need to Talk.

Camillia Creutzfeldt
I think it's admirable that you're forward with your feelings, but let's just be strangers.

Please, sit down, make yourself at home. What am I making tonight? It's nothing much, just a beef bourguignon with short ribs, oxtail, and chuck roast, with some shallots, carrots, celery, and cremini mushrooms. Oh, and the jus is made from the braising liquid, just Beaulieu Vineyard cabernet sauvignon and homemade veal stock. No you don't need to help with anything, I'm almost done. I'm going to plate it now. You like it? That's nice, I'm a very good cook after all.

What time do you have to leave? How soon is soon? An hour? That programming languages class must be hard huh. But before you leave, there's something I need to tell you. Actually, should I? Maybe it's better that I don't. But I really should. Why do I look so anxious? I'm sorry, it's just hard for me to tell just this, but I think I have to get this off my chest. I've been losing sleep over this. So here goes.

Since the day I first met you, from when we were still living in the same dorm in our freshmen year, I had felt this way about you. My feelings for you could not have been any clearer, and I still vividly remember being absorbed by them when you were in my room helping me pack my things for the housing move. I… do not like you as a person. I've made acquaintances with plenty of people whom I dislike, and I must unapologetically tell you that you're among the most detestable. What? You know I have other friends right? Stop blubbering and let me finish. Where was I? Right, did your parents not raise you right? Does your mom smoke? Huh? Why would you think I was going to confess my love to you? Are you stupid? Why would anyone find you even remotely likeable, let alone be able to love you?

Why do I keep making dinner for you? Well, why do you keep asking to come over to my place? I know you don't have much going on in your life between CS classes and living vicariously through romance anime; I do it out of pity.

From now on, I think it's best that we stop seeing each other. In fact, please stop talking to me. I gave you my phone number so that you could have an emergency contact, not so that you can send me pictures of your daily outfits or rhythm game high scores. I want to perceive you as little as possible.

Alright, it's been an hour since we started eating, it's probably a good time for you to leave. Good luck on your lab or project or whatever, I don't care what you actually do in that class. Goodbye and goodnight.

Letter Campaign from the Good Christian Mothers of America

Sponsored by Parents of Every Nice and Impressionable Student

It is clear that Carnegie Melongene University's array of sensual dining options are corrupting our dear, sensitive, children. We call upon the University to, at once, rectify and/or remove these lewd establishments from campus.

- Sara X., Board of Erectors

Hey, so I was putting these in Google Translate Plus and it turns out that La Prima Espresso means 'the primary ejaculation' in Spanish.

- Jeremiah Jeremiah

So, about Schatz. I read about this once in the paper. In Dubai they have these princes that–

- Simu Cutar, Bartow, Georgia

My darling grandson told me over the phone he was going to get "Stacked" with his friends the other day. I was sure I misheard him - I'm getting old you know. I fear what sort of company such a place breeds. But I'll have you know the only thing getting 'stack'd' on my grandchild is books. Books of knowledge. And faith. Also, "Underground?" Really? My grandchild is not doing anything 'underground'. No sir.

- Cindy J., Worthright County, Connecticut

I have a problem with Au Bon Pain. It's French. French for sex, pardon my French. Pain - the little death, la petit mort. It's honestly disgusting the things Carnegie Mellon's admin lets pass by. These… these… socialists are putting horrible ideas in my sweetiepie's head. "All [a]Bout Pain" is apparently what the children call it. I went to college to study the good things –mathematics, circuitry, computers, God, but I watch as my child is forced to experience these deviations.

- Linsdey Q.

I was calling my dear friend Linda and you won't believe the debauchery going on in the Zebra Lounge. It's completely unbecoming of our future leaders. They have them dress up like zebras and give them litter boxes and they lounge around sexually. I can only pray for what becomes of their minds and character. Dear Jesus and Mary…

- Lisa M., Maryland

How to Spice Things Up in the Kitchen

Raytheon Blues
Kiss the Chef

Is cooking just not as exciting as it used to be? Has your gas burner lost its spark? Around halfway through the semester, every upperclassman staying in their own apartment starts to get tired of making their own meals. You might think that there's nothing new to explore, and that it's time to resign yourself to a life of meal prep so vanilla it feels like monthly missionary. But it doesn't have to be this way!

If you want to spice up things in the kitchen, you need to act as soon as the urge strikes. It doesn't matter if it's eleven a.m. on a Wednesday, that recipe for 3-hour baked lasagna is calling your name! Stop inhibiting your desires and be loud and clear about what you want. You want that burrito so gooey that you moan with delight? Then quit being stingy with the cheese! You want some cloyingly sweet aftercare that will make you melt? Then don't skip out on ice cream after dinner! And if your roommate complains about you hogging the kitchen for three hours, tell them you have needs, too.

To feel better about your prowess in the kitchen, it's important to start with good ingredients. Is that brand of butter a smooth enough lubricant for your pan? Does that type of rice really feel soft and warm against your tongue? Even garnish matters—if your scallions aren't scrumptious and your cilantro downright salacious, then you're missing out on a world of culinary pleasure!

A surprising amount of satisfaction comes from the leadup to a meal, rather than the meal itself. The next time you cook, take your time with the preparation. Slide your fingers against the cutting board and get lost in its texture, or hold your hand over the pan and feel the heat radiating off of it. You're leaving your mark on the kitchen every time, you know!

You can also take pleasure in making others feel good. Feed your cooking to a friend and watch their expression as they are overcome with the taste. Their eyes will go half-lidded, their mouth hanging open as they let out a low groan. Ask them to describe exactly what gets them going the most. It can feel good to be at someone's service! If they're interested, try to overstimulate them with a five-course meal of various flavors, getting them to a point where they can't stop eating but are begging you to stop serving them.

All food can go a little stale, but there are endless ways to spice up your culinary experience. If you're looking for more ways to wet your palate, you can always eat out at a restaurant. Maybe even invite a third person into the kitchen, if you've got enough burners to go around. However, I find there's something comforting (and a little sexy) about a sleepy, cuddly breakfast in bed.

Rejected Headlines #43

- "Vore, vat is it good for?": New German single does not chart in the U.S.
- Chaser dog gets tail.
- Ladies, match your GCal to your nipple color.
- Polydectes disappointed to learn that quantum oracles not actually an improvement.
- We paid $100 to CMU Plastic Surgery Club to get a face lift - no strings attached.
- Pregnancy test returns "see me after class".
- Mathematicians confused that WQED still continuing on
- Gimp x Gimp: Sexual awakenings in open-source software.
- How to reject your attractive cousin at Thanksgiving.

All this and more, not in this issue!

CRYPTID CORNER

PRESENTED BY:
ISABELLE FLORENCE



The world's most attractive cow, for those into cows

LA VACA MARINA

10/12/26 - My research into the paranormal brought me out to a farm in South Chile in order to investigate what appeared to be a large-scale case of cattle-tipping. Any rookie cryptozoologist might tell you to expect extraterrestrials, they might even get clever and point out that this is the Grey's bread and butter. The truth, I would learn, was not as straightforward. There was a deep sadness and longing in the eyes of these fallen bovine, and despite efforts to stand them back upright, they consistently fell back onto their sides. This wasn't the work of some impish Martian, these cattle were heartbroken. Now plagued by visions of the heavy-hearted herd, I decided to take a walk through town. As I walked along a canal, out from the water emerged the most beautiful cow I had seen in my life.

It all made sense now. La Vaca Marina, in Southern Chilean folklore, is a water-dwelling spirit of a dead cow, given life by the sea serpent, Caicai Vilu. This wet cow is also, allegedly, the single most attractive cow; so attractive, in fact, that she seduces bulls into being permanently celibate for her. This is part of an elaborate scheme to slowly reduce the world's terrestrial population as a step in Caicai Vilu's war against the land.

The cow locked eyes with mine and beckoned me close. I obliged and approached the canal edge. The cow leaned in and began whispering sweet nothings about a serpent from the sea and some ancient war. It warned me of the evils of sex. It told me to stop eating shellfish. It was then, I recalled that La Vaca Marina, had been poached, skinned, and sold back in 2009. I realized, this was no real Chilean cow spirit, it didn't even speak Spanish. I pulled off the rubber cow mask it was wearing.

I, like all the cows before me, got catfished by two Seventh-day Adventists in a cow costume.

STILL SMOKING CRACK?

Your soul will be DAMNED and enlisted in the infernal army of the

LORD OF THE UNDEAD



This Halloween,

SAY NO TO DRUGS